OFFICIAL WORKOUT BLUEPRINT

THE 155 → 180 LBS AESTHETIC MUSCLE PROTOCOL

The "2-Set Mechanical Failure & Progressive Overload" Master Blueprint



LUKE HAMILTON
Verified Natural Transformation • 155 lbs → 180 lbs

+25 LBS LEAN MASS
8-PACK ABS MAINTAINED

📸 The Visual Proof: 155 lbs Baseline vs. 180 lbs Shredded

The foundation of this system is undeniable real-world execution. Most fitness coaches push "dirty bulking" where you gain 20 lbs of belly fat and lose your jawline, or "junk volume" workouts where you spend 2.5 hours exhausting yourself with zero measurable strength gains.



START: 155 LBS (BASELINE)



180 LBS (8-PACK ABS)



180 LBS (3D BOULDER DELTS)

⚡ The Unbreakable Law: Progressive Overload

"Adding weight is progressive overload. Every single exercise is performed for exactly 2 working sets taken to absolute mechanical failure."

If you hit your target reps on Set 1, you **MUST add 5 lbs** next week. Your muscle fibers only adapt and grow when exposed to mechanical tension they have never experienced before.

🔬 Why 2 Sets Beat 20 Junk Sets (The Science)

When you take a set to true mechanical failure (RPE 10 / 0 reps in reserve), your central nervous system is forced to recruit **100% of high-threshold motor units**. Research proves that sets 1 and 2 deliver 90%+ of the hyper-trophic stimulus. Doing 5 or 6 sets just creates excessive joint inflammation, raises cortisol, and extends recovery time from 48 hours to 6 days.

❌ 20 JUNK SET METHOD

- 2+ hours wasted in the gym
- High joint & tendon wear
- Excess systemic fatigue & cortisol
- Unclear logbook progression

✅ LUKE'S 2-SET FAILURE SYSTEM

- 45–50 minutes max per workout
- 100% high-threshold muscle stimulation
- Rapid CNS recovery between sessions
- Exact poundage tracked every workout

🔴 DAY 1: PUSH PROTOCOL (Chest, Shoulders, Triceps)

2 SETS TO FAILURE ALL Warm up with 2 non-fatiguing ramp-up sets (50% x 8, 75% x 3), then execute 2 all-out working sets to absolute mechanical failure.

EXERCISE	TARGET MUSCLE	WORKING SETS	REP TARGET	EXECUTION & FORM CUE
Flat Chest Press (DB or Machine)	Mid / Lower Pectorals	2 to Fail	6–8 reps	3-sec eccentric down, deep chest stretch at bottom, explosive press
Incline Chest Press (Smith / DB)	Clavicular Upper Pecs	2 to Fail	6–9 reps	30° bench angle; drive elbows inward toward chin for upper shelf
Pec Deck Flye	Inner Sternal Pecs	2 to Fail	8–10 reps	Soft bend in elbows; hold peak contraction for 1 full second
DB Lateral Raises	Lateral Deltoid Head	2 to Fail	10–12 reps	Lean forward 10°, lead with elbows; 5-sec isometric hold on last rep
Cable Lateral Raises (Single Arm)	Constant Tension Delts	2 to Fail	10–12 reps	Set cable at wrist height behind back; maintain smooth continuous tension
Skull Crushers (EZ Bar / DB)	Triceps Long Head	2 to Fail	8–10 reps	Lower bar behind head (not forehead) for maximum long head stretch
Tricep Rope Pushdown	Lateral Triceps	2 to Fail	10–12 reps	Flare rope apart at bottom, lock elbows to your ribcage
Tricep Pushdown Bar	Heavy Overload Triceps	2 to Fail	6–8 reps	Straight bar, lean slightly forward, full strict lockout

🔵 DAY 2: PULL PROTOCOL (Back, Rear Delts, Biceps)

2 SETS TO FAILURE ALL Focus on initiating every pull by driving your elbows down and back, not yanking with your hands.

EXERCISE	TARGET MUSCLE	WORKING SETS	REP TARGET	EXECUTION & FORM CUE
Lat Pulldowns (Close/Neutral)	Upper Lat Width / V-Taper	2 to Fail	8–10 reps	Pull elbows straight into back pockets, lean back 10°
Lat Pullovers (Cable / DB)	Lat Sweep Isolation	2 to Fail	10–12 reps	Soft elbows, sweep bar in a wide arc down to thighs
T-Bar Row	Mid-Back & Rhomboids	2 to Fail	6–8 reps	45° hip hinge; pull to belly button, squeeze shoulder blades 1-sec
Unilateral Row Machine	Single-Side Lat Stretch	2 to Fail	8–10 reps	Allow torso to rotate slightly forward for extreme lat stretch
Hyperextensions	Spinal Erectors / Glutes	2 to Fail	10–12 reps	Neutral spine; hold 45 lb plate across chest, squeeze at top
Reverse Pec Deck	Rear Deltoid Head	2 to Fail	12–15 reps	Drive knuckles back in wide circle; do not squeeze shoulder blades

EXERCISE	TARGET MUSCLE	WORKING SETS	REP TARGET	EXECUTION & FORM CUE
Cable Curl	Bicep Peak / Short Head	2 to Fail	8–10 reps	Elbows pinned slightly in front of torso, strict supination
Cable Hammer Curl (Rope)	Brachialis / Forearm Thickness	2 to Fail	10–12 reps	Neutral thumbs-up grip; builds 3D arm width from the front

DAY 3: LEGS PROTOCOL (Quads, Hamstrings, Adductors, Calves)

2 SETS TO FAILURE ALL Legs trigger the largest systemic growth hormone response. Every set must be executed with deep controlled range of motion.

EXERCISE	TARGET MUSCLE	SETS	REPS	EXECUTION & FORM CUE
Hack Squat	Quad Teardrop & Sweep	2 to Fail	6–9 reps	Feet low on platform for maximum knee flexion; 3-sec descent below parallel
Romanian Deadlifts (RDLs)	Hamstrings & Glutes	2 to Fail	8–10 reps	Push hips straight back like touching a wall; stop when hips stop moving
Hip Abductor Machine	Gluteus Medius / Hip Shelf	2 to Fail	12–15 reps	Lean slightly forward, push knees outward hard, hold 1-sec at spread
Hip Adductor Machine	Inner Thigh Density	2 to Fail	12–15 reps	Control eccentric stretch outwards; squeeze pads together and pause
Leg Extension	Rectus Femoris Quad Peak	2 to Fail	10–12 reps	Pause at top lockout for 1 full second; fight the negative down
Lying / Seated Leg Curl	Hamstring Belly	2 to Fail	8–10 reps	Keep toes dorsiflexed; do not let hips lift off bench during contraction
Standing Calf Raises	Gastrocnemius Calf Meat	2 to Fail	12–15 reps	2-sec dead stop at absolute bottom stretch; explode up on big toes

ABS PROTOCOL (3x Per Week)

Perform at the end of workouts or on rest days: **2 sets to absolute failure**.

EXERCISE	TARGET AREA	SETS	TECHNIQUE & EXECUTION CUE
Cable / Decline Ab Crunches	Upper & Mid 6-Pack Core	2 to Fail	Round your spine into a tight ball; exhale all air at peak crunch
Hanging / Captain's Chair Leg Raises	Lower Ab Pouch & Compression	2 to Fail	Do not just swing legs; curl your pelvis UP toward your ribcage

Central Nervous System & Sleep Matrix

Muscle growth does not happen during the workout — it happens during deep stage 3 and REM sleep when growth hormone surges. Aim for **7.5 to 8.5 hours of uninterrupted sleep**. Supplement stack: 5g Creatine Monohydrate daily, 400mg Magnesium Glycinate before bed, and electrolytes with pre-workout.

🥩 The 155 ➔ 180 Lean Mass Nutrition Matrix

Gaining 25 lbs of dense muscle without gaining belly fat requires a calibrated caloric surplus. If you eat 1,000 extra calories a day, 80% goes to body fat. If you eat a controlled **+350–500 kcal surplus**, 90%+ is partitioned directly into myofibrillar muscle tissue.

DAILY PROTEIN	COMPLEX CARBS	HEALTHY FATS
180g – 195g	**340g – 380g**	**65g – 75g**
Chicken, 93/7 beef, eggs, Greek yogurt, whey isolate	Jasmine rice, oats, sweet potatoes, cream of rice	Olive oil, natural peanut butter, avocados, whole eggs

🏆 Luke's 3 Non-Negotiable Nutrition Rules:

1. **85% Whole Clean Foods:** Fast food spikes estrogen and causes water retention. Whole clean foods fuel skin-splitting muscle pumps and vascularity.
2. **1 Full Gallon of Water Daily:** Muscle is 70% water. Dehydration drops strength by 15% immediately.
3. **10,000 Steps Daily:** Never skip your daily walk. It keeps your insulin sensitivity high so surplus calories are pushed into muscle glycogen rather than lower belly fat.

📓 Weekly Progressive Overload Logbook Sheet

Print this sheet or log it in your notes app. **Every session, your goal is to beat the numbers from the previous week.**

EXERCISE	WEEK 1 TARGET	WEEK 2 TARGET	WEEK 3 TARGET	WEEK 4 TARGET	NEXT ACTION CUE
Flat Chest Press	185 lbs x 8	190 lbs x 7	190 lbs x 8	195 lbs x 6	**+5 lbs when hitting 8 reps**
Hack Squat	315 lbs x 8	325 lbs x 7	325 lbs x 9	335 lbs x 7	**+10 lbs when hitting 9 reps**
T-Bar Row	135 lbs x 9	145 lbs x 7	145 lbs x 8	150 lbs x 7	**+5 lbs when hitting 8 reps**
Incline Chest Press	155 lbs x 8	160 lbs x 7	160 lbs x 8	165 lbs x 6	**+5 lbs when hitting 8 reps**
DB Lateral Raises	25 lbs x 12	25 lbs x 12+	30 lbs x 10	30 lbs x 12	**+5 lbs after 12 strict reps**

CONSISTENCY + TRUE FAILURE = UNSTOPPABLE GROWTH

For 1-on-1 Mentorship & Form Audits: hluke2057@gmail.com